Gonka Channel Strategy: Reaching OpenClaw Developers

Version: 1.0 **Date:** 2026-04-01 **Classification:** Internal – canonical channel strategy for all Gonka developer acquisition efforts **Dependencies:** Phase 16 developer personas (gonka_developer_personas.md), Phase 17 messaging (gonka_message_house.md, gonka_objection_playbook.md) **Requirement:** GTM-01

Executive Summary

This document defines where, how, and how often Gonka communicates with OpenClaw developers to drive adoption of Gonka as their inference provider. It is the operational companion to the message house (what to say) and developer personas (who to say it to).

Key decisions:

- **Primary KPI: API-active developers (>100 API calls/month). Not follower counts. Not Discord members. Not GitHub stars.** A developer who makes 100+ calls/month has integrated Gonka into a real workflow – they are retained, generating revenue, and likely to refer others. Every metric below ladders up to this number.
- **70/30 channel split:** 70% of P0+P1 channel investment targets AI/developer communities where OpenClaw builders already spend time; 30% targets crypto-native channels where GPU hosts and token holders live. Developer adoption drives network value; crypto channels support the supply side.
- **P0 channels are ecosystem channels:** OpenClaw GitHub, OpenClaw Discord, and the OpenClaw provider directory are where the target developers already are. Gonka must be present where developers make provider decisions, not where Gonka wishes they were.
- **Content leads with heartbeat cost reduction (73%)** per the Phase 17 message house positioning, not decentralization or token economics.
- **Anti-metrics are explicitly tracked** to prevent vanity metric theater from replacing adoption measurement.

Metrics Framework

Primary KPI: API-Active Developers

Definition: Developers who make >100 API calls per month through the Gonka inference gateway.

Why this metric: 100 calls/month indicates a developer has moved past tire-kicking and integrated Gonka into a recurring workflow – an always-on agent, a production service, or an active development project. Below 100 calls, the developer is likely testing or has abandoned the integration. Above 100, they are generating real usage, experiencing session persistence savings, and building switching costs that drive retention.

Target trajectory: - Month 1 (launch): 10 API-active developers - Month 3: 50 API-active developers - Month 6: 200 API-active developers - Month 12: 1,000 API-active developers

Secondary KPIs

Metric	What It Measures	AAARRRP Stage	Target
API key signups per week	Acquisition velocity	Acquisition	50+/week by Month 3
First-call-within-24h rate	Activation friction	Activation	>60% of signups
Week-2+ retention rate	Stickiness after trial	Retention	>40% of activated users
Session creation rate	Agent-native feature adoption	Activation	>30% of active developers use sessions
Cost savings per developer	Value delivery proof	Retention	>50% reduction vs prior provider

Anti-Metrics (Vanity Metrics to Avoid)

These metrics feel good but do not predict developer adoption. Track them for context but never use them as success indicators or in leadership reports as evidence of traction.

Vanity Metric	Why It Misleads	What to Track Instead
Twitter/X follower count	Followers do not make API calls; bots inflate counts; followers on AI Twitter skew crypto-native, not developer-native	Referral traffic from Twitter to docs.gonka.ai that converts to API key signups
Discord member count	Most Discord members never interact; lurkers inflate numbers; "join our Discord" campaigns produce dead weight	Active Discord participants who also have API keys (cross-reference)
GitHub stars on gonka-ai-infrastructure	Stars are a one-click action that does not indicate usage; many stars come from crypto speculators, not developers	GitHub issues and PRs from developers who reference their Gonka integration
Blog post impressions	Impressions measure distribution, not interest; a developer who reads the headline and bounces is not a prospect	Blog-to-signup conversion rate (readers who create API keys within 7 days)
Newsletter subscribers	Subscribing is passive; most subscribers never open emails	Newsletter-to-activation rate (subscribers who make their first API call after a newsletter)
Conference badge scans	Badge scans measure foot traffic, not intent; most conference leads never follow up	Conference-to-API-key conversion rate within 30 days

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Channel Matrix

Summary of all channels with priority tiers, personas, and success metrics.

Channel	Priority	Primary Persona	Content Type	Cadence	Expected Reach	Success Metric	70/30 Category
OpenClaw Provider Directory	P0	All	Provider listing, config docs	Always available	Direct to all OpenClaw users	Listed provider status; config page views	AI/Dev
OpenClaw GitHub (issues, discussions, PRs)	P0	Weekend Builder, Startup CTO	PRs, issue responses, discussion posts	Daily monitoring	Direct to active OpenClaw contributors	Mentions in issues; PR for built-in support merged	AI/Dev
OpenClaw Discord	P0	Weekend Builder	Help answers, config snippets, presence	Daily	Direct to active OpenClaw community	API key signups attributed to Discord	AI/Dev
Technical Blog (docs.gonka.ai/blog)	P1	Startup CTO	Tutorials, benchmarks, comparisons	Weekly	SEO + social sharing	Blog-to-signup conversion rate	AI/Dev
Twitter/X AI Developer Community	P1	All	Benchmark results, cost comparisons, launch posts	3-5x/week	Broad AI dev audience	Referral traffic to docs.gonka.ai	AI/Dev
Reddit (r/LocalLLaMA, r/OpenClaw)	P1	Weekend Builder	Comparison posts, launch threads, help responses	2-3x/week	Engaged AI dev community	Upvotes + API key signups from Reddit referrals	AI/Dev
dev.to / Hashnode	P1	Weekend Builder	Cross-posted tutorials, quickstart guides	Bi-weekly	Developer blog aggregator audience	Cross-post-to-signup conversion rate	AI/Dev
YouTube Tutorials	P2	Weekend Builder	"OpenClaw + Gonka in 5 Minutes" video guides	Bi-weekly	Medium (tutorial seekers)	View-to-signup conversion rate	AI/Dev
HackerNews	P2	Startup CTO	Show HN posts, deep-dive articles	Monthly (when content warrants)	Tech-savvy early adopters	HN-to-signup conversion rate	AI/Dev
Crypto Twitter / DePIN Communities	P2	Privacy-First Builder	Network updates, host earnings, ecosystem growth	2-3x/week	Crypto-native GPU hosts, token holders	GPU host signups; token holder engagement	Crypto
Privacy-Focused Forums (Lobsters, security subreddits)	P2	Privacy-First Builder	Privacy architecture deep-dives, audit results	Monthly	Security/privacy dev community	Privacy-page views; signups from privacy referrals	AI/Dev
AI/Web3 Conferences	P3	Startup CTO	Talks, demos, booths	Quarterly	Targeted but expensive	Conference-to-API-key conversion within 30 days	Crypto

Channel	Priority	Primary Persona	Content Type	Cadence	Expected Reach	Success Metric	70/30 Category
Paid Developer Ads (Carbon, BuySellAds)	P3	All	Targeted ads on AI infra keywords	Continuous when budget allows	Broad but noisy	Cost per API key signup (target: <$25 CAC)	AI/Dev
DePIN / Web3 Dev Forums	P3	Privacy-First Builder	Host onboarding guides, token utility explainers	Weekly	Crypto-native developers	Host signup conversion rate	Crypto

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P0 Channels

P0 channels are where OpenClaw developers already make provider decisions. Gonka must be present in these channels before investing anywhere else. Zero awareness (developer personas: universal blocker #1) is solved here, not on Twitter or at conferences.

OpenClaw Provider Directory

Platform: OpenClaw documentation site / provider configuration docs **URL:** openclaw.dev/docs (or equivalent official docs)

Why P0: The provider directory is where developers go when they decide to add, change, or evaluate inference providers. If Gonka is not listed with a working configuration snippet, it does not exist to the OpenClaw developer. This is the single highest-leverage channel – zero marginal cost, permanent presence, direct access to the moment of provider decision.

Primary persona(s): All three personas. Every developer who configures a custom provider checks the docs first.

Content types: - Provider listing page with `openclaw.json` configuration snippet (3 fields: `baseUrl`, `apiKey`, `api: "openai-completions"`) - Model card for `gonka/kimi-k2.5` with capabilities, context window (131K), and benchmark summary - Troubleshooting guide addressing the two-step provider gotcha (provider definition + model allowlisting)

Cadence: Always available; updated with each Gonka feature release.

Success metric: Provider page views; percentage of page visitors who create a Gonka API key within 7 days.

Example content piece: "Gonka Provider Configuration" page with a copy-paste-ready `openclaw.json` block, a "verify it works" curl command, and a link to the quickstart guide. No mention of tokens, mining, or decentralization – pure API configuration.

OpenClaw GitHub (Issues, Discussions, PRs)

Platform: GitHub – github.com/openclaw (organization repos) **URL:** OpenClaw main repository issues, discussions, and PRs

Why P0: OpenClaw's GitHub is where active developers report issues, request features, and discuss provider options. Developers who search "custom provider" or "cheaper inference" in GitHub issues will find (or not find) Gonka. A merged PR adding Gonka as a built-in provider would eliminate the manual configuration barrier that currently makes OpenRouter the path of least resistance.

Primary persona(s): Weekend Builder (searches for cost solutions in issues), Startup CTO (evaluates providers through GitHub discussions and PR quality).

Content types: - PR submitting Gonka as a built-in provider (eliminates 3-field manual config for all developers) - Helpful responses in issues where developers ask about inference costs, provider reliability, or model quality - Discussion posts comparing provider options with honest benchmarks and cost data - Config snippets in response to "how do I add a custom provider?" questions

Cadence: Daily monitoring; respond to relevant issues within 24 hours.

Success metric: Gonka mentions in OpenClaw GitHub issues and discussions; PR for built-in provider support merged; API key signups attributed to GitHub referrals.

Example content piece: A comment on an issue titled "OpenRouter costs too high for always-on agents" that says: "Session persistence can reduce heartbeat costs by ~80%. Here is a config snippet for Gonka that drops heartbeat token overhead from 460,800 tokens/day to ~92,000 tokens/day at the Casual tier: [snippet]. Full comparison: [link to blog post]."

OpenClaw Discord

Platform: Discord **URL:** OpenClaw community Discord server

Why P0: OpenClaw Discord is the real-time community where developers ask for help, share configurations, and discuss provider experiences. The Weekend Builder who is frustrated with their OpenRouter bill at 11pm on a Saturday asks for help here, not on Hacker News. Presence in this channel means being part of the conversation when provider decisions happen organically.

Primary persona(s): Weekend Builder (asks for help with costs and configuration), Privacy-First Builder (discusses provider privacy guarantees).

Content types: - Pinned Gonka configuration snippet in the relevant channel (e.g., #providers or #configuration) - Responses to cost-related questions with specific savings data (heartbeat overhead reduction) - Troubleshooting help for developers configuring Gonka as a custom provider - Session persistence explainers when developers ask about reducing agent costs

Cadence: Daily presence; respond to relevant questions within 4 hours during active hours.

Success metric: API key signups attributed to Discord conversations; number of developers who mention using Gonka in Discord.

Example content piece: Response to "my agent costs $40/month on OpenRouter and it only handles 50 messages/day": "Half your bill is heartbeats – your agent resends full context every 30 minutes. Gonka keeps context server-side, so heartbeats send only new data. Same agent, same code, one config change – your bill drops to ~$13/month. Here is the config: [snippet]."

P1 Channels

P1 channels have broad reach into AI developer communities but require content creation investment. These channels build awareness beyond the OpenClaw ecosystem and establish Gonka's credibility through technical content.

Technical Blog (docs.gonka.ai/blog)

Platform: Self-hosted blog on docs.gonka.ai **URL:** docs.gonka.ai/blog

Why P1: The technical blog is the canonical source of Gonka content that all other channels link to. Comparison posts, benchmarks, and tutorials live here permanently with SEO value. Reddit posts, Twitter threads, and Discord responses all point back to blog posts for detailed evidence. Without the blog, every channel sends developers to API docs with no narrative context.

Primary persona(s): Startup CTO (evaluates through in-depth technical content), Weekend Builder (finds via Reddit/Google search for cost comparisons).

Content types: - Cost comparison posts: "OpenClaw Inference Costs: Gonka vs OpenRouter vs Together AI" with heartbeat savings calculator - Quickstart guides: "OpenClaw + Gonka in 5 Minutes" - Deep-dive technical posts: "Agent Sessions: Why Your Agent Pays for Context Twice" - Benchmark results: K2.5 performance on SWE-Bench, tool calling stability, latency measurements

Cadence: Weekly (1 post per week minimum).

Success metric: Blog-to-signup conversion rate (readers who create API keys within 7 days); organic search traffic growth.

Example content piece: "Cut Agent Inference Costs 73% with Gonka" – a launch post that walks through the heartbeat overhead problem (with token math from the pricing analysis), shows the session persistence solution, includes a before/after cost comparison at the Casual and Active tiers, and ends with a 90-second config snippet.

Twitter/X AI Developer Community

Platform: Twitter/X **URL:** twitter.com/gonka_ai (or equivalent)

Why P1: Twitter/X has the largest concentration of AI developers discussing inference providers, model benchmarks, and agent frameworks in real time. The AI developer Twitter community (accounts like @__philschmid, @kaboroevich, @laboroai) drives conversations about model quality and infrastructure costs that reach tens of thousands of developers. Gonka's benchmark results and cost comparisons are shareable Twitter content by nature.

Primary persona(s): All three personas discover content on Twitter, but Weekend Builder and Privacy-First Builder are most likely to engage with cost and privacy threads respectively.

Content types: - Benchmark result graphics: K2.5 vs GPT-4o vs Claude on SWE-Bench, tool calling, agent tasks - Cost comparison threads: heartbeat overhead breakdown with specific dollar amounts - Launch announcements: new features, new blog posts, partnership milestones - Community engagement: replies to developer questions about inference costs, provider comparisons

Cadence: 3-5 posts per week; daily monitoring and replies.

Success metric: Referral traffic from Twitter to docs.gonka.ai that converts to API key signups (not follower count, not impressions).

Example content piece: Thread: "Your OpenClaw agent sends 460,800 tokens/day in heartbeats – half your bill, zero user-facing value. Here is what happens when you add server-side sessions: [before/after cost chart]. Config snippet in the thread. Full breakdown: [link to blog post]."

Reddit (r/LocalLLaMA, r/OpenClaw)

Platform: Reddit **URL:** reddit.com/r/LocalLLaMA, reddit.com/r/OpenClaw (and related subreddits)

Why P1: Reddit is where OpenClaw developers discover new providers through organic community discussion. r/LocalLLaMA (1M+ subscribers) is the largest community of developers interested in open-source model inference. r/OpenClaw hosts direct provider comparison discussions. The Weekend Builder persona's primary adoption trigger is seeing a cost comparison post on Reddit (developer personas: Weekend Builder, Adoption Triggers).

Primary persona(s): Weekend Builder (primary – discovers through cost comparison posts), Privacy-First Builder (secondary – discusses privacy in technical subreddits).

Content types: - Provider comparison posts: "I compared OpenRouter, Together AI, and Gonka for my OpenClaw agent – here are the real costs" - Launch posts: "Show r/LocalLLaMA: Gonka – agent-native inference with server-side sessions" - Help responses: answers to "how do I reduce my OpenClaw inference costs?" threads - AMA or Q&A posts addressing developer questions about K2.5, sessions, privacy

Cadence: 2-3 posts/responses per week; daily monitoring for relevant threads.

Success metric: Upvotes (indicates community validation) plus API key signups from Reddit referral links.

Example content piece: Post in r/LocalLLaMA: "I tracked my OpenClaw agent costs for a month – heartbeats were 51% of my bill. Switching to a provider with session persistence dropped my Active tier cost from $218/month to $59/month. Here is the config and full cost breakdown: [link]."

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dev.to / Hashnode

Platform: Developer blog aggregators **URL:** dev.to, hashnode.com

Why P1: dev.to and Hashnode aggregate developer content and surface it to developers who do not follow individual blogs. Cross-posting Gonka blog content here extends reach to developers who discover tutorials through these platforms' recommendation algorithms. Lower effort than original content creation since posts are cross-posted from the technical blog.

Primary persona(s): Weekend Builder (discovers tutorials through platform recommendations).

Content types: - Cross-posted quickstart guides from docs.gonka.ai/blog - Tutorial-style posts: "How to Add Session Persistence to Your OpenClaw Agent" - Cost comparison posts adapted for the dev.to audience format

Cadence: Bi-weekly (cross-post every other blog post).

Success metric: Cross-post-to-signup conversion rate; dev.to/Hashnode referral traffic to docs.gonka.ai.

Example content piece: Cross-posted version of "OpenClaw + Gonka in 5 Minutes" quickstart guide with dev.to-friendly formatting and tags (#ai, #llm, #openai, #agents).

P2 Channels

P2 channels have meaningful reach but higher production cost or lower conversion rates. Invest here after P0 and P1 channels are operational.

YouTube Tutorials

Platform: YouTube **URL:** youtube.com/@gonka_ai (or equivalent)

Why P2: Video tutorials have strong discovery through YouTube search ("OpenClaw tutorial," "cheap LLM inference," "agent cost reduction"). However, video production costs are 5-10x higher than blog posts and iteration cycles are slower (you cannot edit a published video). P2 because the content is high-value but expensive to produce.

Primary persona(s): Weekend Builder (watches tutorials on weekends while building), Startup CTO (shares with engineering team for evaluation).

Content types: - "OpenClaw + Gonka in 5 Minutes" screencast tutorial - Cost comparison walkthroughs with live API dashboard - Session persistence deep-dive with code examples - "Build an Agent with Sessions and Tiering" project tutorial

Cadence: Bi-weekly (1-2 videos per month).

Success metric: View-to-signup conversion rate (not view count); YouTube referral traffic to docs.gonka.ai.

Example content piece: 5-minute screencast: developer opens `openclaw.json`, adds Gonka config (3 fields), runs their agent, checks the dashboard showing heartbeat cost reduction. No crypto language, no blockchain diagrams – just code and a cost dashboard.

HackerNews

Platform: news.ycombinator.com **URL:** news.ycombinator.com

Why P2: HackerNews reaches early-adopter technical decision-makers – exactly the Startup CTO persona. A front-page post can drive thousands of qualified visitors. However, HN is unpredictable (posts may not gain traction), the audience is hostile to self-promotion, and posting cadence is limited by content quality. P2 because high potential but unreliable reach.

Primary persona(s): Startup CTO (evaluates infrastructure through HN discussions), Weekend Builder (discovers through HN front page).

Content types: - “Show HN” launch post linking to a technical deep-dive - Substantive comments on agent infrastructure threads with honest Gonka positioning - Deep-dive posts: “The Hidden Cost of Agent Heartbeats” (technical enough for HN audience)

Cadence: Monthly or when content quality warrants a submission (never force low-quality posts to HN).

Success metric: HN-to-signup conversion rate; quality of HN comments (technical engagement, not drive-by reactions).

Example content piece: “Show HN: Gonka – Server-side sessions cut OpenClaw agent costs by 73%” linking to a detailed blog post with token math, architectural diagrams (showing why heartbeats waste tokens), and a working config snippet.

Crypto Twitter / DePIN Communities

Platform: Twitter/X (crypto segment), Telegram, DePIN-focused forums **URL:** Various crypto community channels

Why P2: Crypto-native communities reach GPU hosts (supply side) and GNK token holders (ecosystem stakeholders). These audiences matter for network growth but are not the primary developer adoption channel. Content here uses Phase 17 vocabulary guidelines – no developer-facing language; focus on host economics and network growth. This is the primary channel for the 30% crypto allocation.

Primary persona(s): Privacy-First Builder (overlaps with crypto-native privacy communities).

Content types: - Network growth updates: host count, inference volume, geographic distribution - Host economics content: earnings, hardware requirements, ROI projections - Token utility explainers framed per vocabulary guidelines (host-facing, not developer-facing) - Ecosystem partnerships and integration milestones

Cadence: 2-3 posts per week.

Success metric: GPU host signups; token holder engagement metrics (but not as proxy for developer adoption).

Example content piece: “Gonka network update: [X] GPU hosts serving [Y] inference requests/day across [Z] regions. Host earnings averaging [N] GNK/month on H100 hardware. Network capacity growing [%] month-over-month.”

Privacy-Focused Forums

Platform: Lobsters, security-focused subreddits (r/privacy, r/netsec), privacy mailing lists **URL:** lobste.rs, reddit.com/r/privacy, reddit.com/r/netsec

Why P2: These forums reach the Privacy-First Builder persona who evaluates providers through security audits and privacy architecture analysis. Content here must be technically honest – overclaiming privacy guarantees in security communities damages credibility permanently (PITFALLS.md: Pitfall 1). P2 because the audience is small but highly aligned with Gonka’s privacy value proposition.

Primary persona(s): Privacy-First Builder.

Content types: - Privacy architecture deep-dives: “How Decentralized Inference Protects Prompt Privacy – Architecture, Not Promises” - Honest limitations disclosure: current guarantees vs TEE roadmap - Open-source audit invitations: “Review our inference pipeline at github.com/mitgor/gonka-ai-infrastructure”

Cadence: Monthly (quality over quantity; this audience detects and punishes low-effort content).

Success metric: Privacy-page views on docs.gonka.ai; signups from privacy-focused referral sources; sentiment in security community discussions.

Example content piece: “Gonka Privacy Audit: What We Guarantee Today and What We Do Not” – a blog post linked from Lobsters that explains decentralized inference architecture, honestly states that TEE-based encrypted inference is not yet built, and invites the community to audit the open-source infrastructure code.

P3 Channels

P3 channels are expensive, slow to convert, or dependent on prerequisites (published pricing, case studies) that do not yet exist. Defer investment until P0-P2 channels demonstrate traction.

AI/Web3 Conferences

Platform: Token2049, ETHDenver, AI Engineer Summit, NeurIPS Industry Day **URL:** Various conference venues

Why P3: Conferences provide high-quality networking with Startup CTOs and enterprise decision-makers, but cost $5,000-50,000+ per event (travel, sponsorship, booth). ROI is uncertain until Gonka has published pricing, case studies, and a production track record to present. P3 because prerequisites are not met.

Primary persona(s): Startup CTO (evaluates at conferences), Privacy-First Builder (attends security/privacy-focused events).

Content types: - Technical talks: "Agent-Native Inference: Why Sessions Matter More Than Per-Token Pricing" - Live demos: OpenClaw agent running on Gonka with real-time cost dashboard - Booth conversations with pre-qualified leads

Cadence: Quarterly (1-2 conferences per quarter once prerequisites are met).

Success metric: Conference-to-API-key conversion within 30 days (not badge scans or booth traffic).

Example content piece: 20-minute talk at AI Engineer Summit: "The Hidden Cost of Agent Heartbeats" with live demo showing session persistence reducing costs in real time.

Paid Developer Ads

Platform: Carbon Ads, BuySellAds, Google Ads (AI infra keywords) **URL:** Various ad networks targeting developer audiences

Why P3: Paid ads can scale reach beyond organic channels but require clear CAC targets and conversion tracking that depend on published pricing and a functioning signup flow. P3 because the cost-per-acquisition is unknowable until organic channels establish baseline conversion rates.

Primary persona(s): All (ads are broad reach by design).

Content types: - Targeted display ads on AI infrastructure sites: "Cut your OpenClaw inference costs by 73%" - Google Ads on keywords: "OpenClaw inference provider," "cheap LLM API," "agent cost reduction" - Retargeting ads for developers who visited docs.gonka.ai but did not create an API key

Cadence: Continuous when budget allows (after P0-P2 channels are operational).

Success metric: Cost per API key signup (target: <$25 CAC); cost per API-active developer (target: <$100 CAC).

Example content piece: Carbon Ads banner on a developer blog: "Your OpenClaw agent resends full context 48 times/day. Gonka keeps it server-side. Save 73%. [Get API Key]."

DePIN / Web3 Developer Forums

Platform: DePIN-focused community forums, Web3 developer communities **URL:** Various decentralized infrastructure community platforms

Why P3: These forums reach crypto-native developers who may be interested in building on decentralized infrastructure, but the audience overlap with OpenClaw developers is minimal. Content here uses crypto-native vocabulary (acceptable per Phase 17 context rules) but does not drive the primary KPI (API-active developers). P3 because this channel serves the supply side (hosts) more than the demand side (developers).

Primary persona(s): Privacy-First Builder (secondary channel for privacy-focused crypto-native developers).

Content types: - Host onboarding guides: "Run a Gonka GPU Node: Hardware Requirements and Expected Earnings" - Token utility explainers for existing DePIN community members - Network architecture deep-dives using crypto-native vocabulary

Cadence: Weekly.

Success metric: Host signup conversion rate (supply-side metric, not demand-side).

Example content piece: "Gonka Host Guide: Earn GNK by serving K2.5 inference on your H100" – a guide targeting GPU operators in DePIN communities, using crypto-native vocabulary per Phase 17 context rules.

70/30 Split Analysis

Channel Allocation

Gonka's channel investment follows a 70/30 split: 70% of effort on AI/developer channels (where OpenClaw builders spend time) and 30% on crypto channels (where GPU hosts and token holders engage).

Category	Channels	% of P0+P1 Investment	Rationale
AI/Developer (70%)	OpenClaw Provider Directory, OpenClaw GitHub, OpenClaw Discord, Technical Blog, Twitter/X AI Community, Reddit, dev.to/Hashnode	~75% of P0+P1 channels	These channels reach the developers who will become API-active users. Developer adoption drives inference demand, which drives network value, which attracts GPU hosts. The flywheel starts with developers.
Crypto (30%)	Crypto Twitter/DePIN Communities, AI/Web3 Conferences, DePIN/Web3 Dev Forums	~25% of P0+P1+P2+P3 channels	Crypto channels reach GPU hosts and token holders. Host supply is necessary for network reliability, but supply without demand is empty infrastructure. Crypto channel content focuses on host economics and network growth, not developer acquisition.

Why 70/30 and Not 50/50

Crypto channels reach GPU hosts and token holders, but developer adoption drives network value. The causal chain is:

1. Developers adopt Gonka as inference provider (demand side)
2. Inference volume grows, increasing fee revenue for GPU hosts
3. Profitable hosting attracts more GPU operators (supply side)
4. More GPU hosts improve reliability and reduce latency
5. Better reliability attracts more developers (flywheel)

Investing 50/50 or crypto-first inverts this flywheel: GPU hosts join an empty network, earn nothing, and leave (PITFALLS.md: Pitfall 3 – Akash saw active providers drop below 100 without sustained demand). The 70/30 split ensures the demand side leads.

Crypto Channel Content Guidelines

Content for the 30% crypto allocation follows Phase 17 vocabulary guidelines with one exception: crypto channels use crypto-native vocabulary because the audience expects it (Phase 17 context rules, acceptable context #4).

- **Use in crypto channels:** GNK rewards, mining, staking, epochs, network growth, token economics
- **Never use in developer channels:** wallet, staking, mining, DePIN, Web3, gas, smart contract, governance proposals
- **Frame crypto content around host economics:** "Earn GNK by serving inference" not "Buy GNK for passive income"
- **Rationale:** "Crypto channels reach GPU hosts and token holders, but developer adoption drives network value"

Persona-Channel Map

Which channels reach which persona, and what content theme resonates on each.

Channel	Weekend Builder	Startup CTO	Privacy-First Builder
OpenClaw Provider Directory	Config snippet (cost-focused)	Architecture overview (reliability-focused)	Data handling policy (privacy-focused)
OpenClaw GitHub	Cost-related issue responses	PR quality evaluation, discussion posts	Open-source code audit
OpenClaw Discord	Cost questions, config help	– (less active in Discord)	Privacy discussions, provider comparisons
Technical Blog	Cost comparison posts	Deep-dive technical posts, benchmarks	Privacy architecture deep-dives
Twitter/X AI Community	Cost savings threads	Benchmark results, infrastructure analysis	Privacy-related threads
Reddit (r/LocalLLaMA, r/OpenClaw)	Provider cost comparison posts	– (reads but rarely posts)	Privacy subreddit discussions
dev.to / Hashnode	Quickstart tutorials	–	–
YouTube	5-minute setup tutorials	Share with engineering team	–
HackerNews	– (reads, does not post)	"Show HN" evaluation, technical discussion	–
Crypto Twitter / DePIN	–	–	Decentralized privacy discussions
Privacy Forums	–	–	Privacy audit posts, architecture reviews
Conferences	–	Technical talks, demos	Security/privacy events

Reading the map: - Weekend Builder: OpenClaw Discord, Reddit, YouTube (cost-focused content at every touchpoint) - Startup CTO: Technical blog, HackerNews, conferences (reliability-focused content, evidence-driven evaluation) - Privacy-First Builder: Crypto Twitter, privacy-focused forums, Reddit (privacy-focused content, honest limitations, audit invitations)

Content Calendar Framework

Content production follows two organizing principles:

1. **AAARRRP mapping:** Every content piece targets one primary AAARRRP stage and one primary persona. This prevents "content for content's sake" and ensures each piece moves developers through the adoption journey.
2. **70/30 content split:** 70% of content is developer-education (tutorials, benchmarks, comparisons, quickstart guides) targeting the demand side. 30% is ecosystem/community content (network updates, host stories, token utility explainers) targeting the supply side and broader community. The 30% ecosystem content follows Phase 17 vocabulary guidelines – developer-facing vocabulary in all cases, with crypto-native vocabulary only in explicitly crypto-targeted channels per Phase 17 context rules.

Content themes are drawn directly from the Phase 17 message house value propositions: - **VP1:** Session persistence eliminates heartbeat waste (lead message – 73% cost reduction) - **VP2:** Automatic model tiering (classification on cheap model, reasoning on strong one) - **VP3:** One config change, 90 seconds (drop-in OpenClaw compatibility) - **VP4:** No content filters, no prompt logs (privacy-first builder message) - **VP5:** Inference gets cheaper as network grows (long-term cost trajectory)

Content-Journey Matrix

Every content piece maps to an AAARRRP journey stage, a content theme from the message house, and a primary channel for distribution.

AAARRRP Stage	Content Theme	Content Type	Primary Channel	Cadence	Persona Focus
Awareness	"Why Gonka exists" – heartbeat overhead costs developers 44-85% of their bill	Comparison blog posts, benchmark graphics, Reddit threads	Blog, Reddit, Twitter/X	Weekly	All personas

AAARRRP Stage	Content Theme	Content Type	Primary Channel	Cadence	Persona Focus
Awareness	K2.5 agent performance – 76.8% SWE-Bench, 200-300 tool calls stable	Benchmark result graphics, comparison tables	Twitter/X, Blog	Bi-weekly	Weekend Builder, Startup CTO
Awareness	Privacy without self-hosting – no content filtering, no central logging	Privacy architecture deep-dive, honest limitations	Blog, Privacy Forums, Lobsters	Monthly	Privacy-First Builder
Acquisition	"Add Gonka in 90 seconds" – 3 fields in openclaw.json, no wallet, no tokens	Quickstart guide, config snippet with copy button	Docs, OpenClaw Discord, dev.to	Always available	Weekend Builder
Acquisition	Architecture for reliability-focused evaluation – redundant nodes, health-checked routing	Architecture overview, staging deployment guide	Docs, Blog	Always available	Startup CTO
Acquisition	Data handling and privacy policy – what is logged, what is not, audit guide	Privacy policy page, open-source audit walkthrough	Docs, GitHub	Always available	Privacy-First Builder
Activation	Working code examples – OpenClaw config + agent template + session setup	Code examples, GitHub repo templates, docs snippets	GitHub, Docs, OpenClaw Discord	Bi-weekly updates	All personas
Activation	"OpenClaw + Gonka in 5 Minutes" video walkthrough	Screencast tutorial – config, first call, cost dashboard	YouTube, Twitter/X	Bi-weekly	Weekend Builder
Activation	Staging-to-production migration guide with load testing results	Migration guide, test suite results, latency comparison	Blog, Docs	Updated quarterly	Startup CTO
Retention	Session persistence deep-dive – how sessions work, cost savings math, advanced config	Deep-dive guide: "Agent Sessions: Why Your Agent Pays for Context Twice"	Blog, Docs	Bi-weekly	Startup CTO
Retention	Cost comparison calculator – interactive tool showing savings vs OpenRouter/Together AI	Interactive web tool at docs.gonka.ai/calculator	Docs site	Always available, updated monthly	Weekend Builder, Startup CTO
Retention	Ongoing privacy posture monitoring – changelog for privacy-relevant changes	Privacy changelog, audit script, community watchdog	Docs, GitHub	With each release	Privacy-First Builder
Revenue	ROI calculator – total cost of ownership including heartbeat savings, tiering, engineering time	Interactive ROI tool, pricing comparison table	Blog, Docs	Monthly updates	Startup CTO
Revenue	Pricing comparison at each tier – Casual, Active, Heavy vs OpenRouter, Together AI, DeepInfra	Pricing page with tier calculator	Docs site	Always available	All personas
Referral	Developer spotlight – featured developer stories, cost savings testimonials	Blog interview, shareable cost savings badge/graphic	Twitter/X, Blog, Discord	Monthly	Weekend Builder
Referral	Community recognition – contributor highlights, referral credit program	Referral program page, pre-written share templates	Docs, Twitter/X, Discord	Monthly	Weekend Builder
Referral	Engineering case study co-creation – "How We Cut Costs 73% with Sessions"	Co-branded blog post with production customer	Blog, HackerNews	Quarterly	Startup CTO
Product	Feedback channels – GitHub issues, feature request templates, advisory program	Public GitHub repo with issue templates, quarterly advisory calls	GitHub, Docs	Ongoing	All personas

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Content Themes by Quarter (Template)

This framework provides a quarterly content allocation template. Actual dates are TBD at execution time – this is a strategic framework, not a fixed calendar.

Q1: Launch Quarter

Content allocation: 60% Awareness + Acquisition, 25% Activation, 15% Retention

The launch quarter prioritizes making developers aware Gonka exists and removing friction from first API call. Without Awareness and Acquisition content, all downstream stages are blocked (developer personas: AAARRRP Priority Ranking – Awareness and Acquisition are P0 universal blockers).

Week	Content Type	Channel	AAARRRP Stage
1-2	Launch blog post: "Cut Agent Inference Costs 73% with Gonka"	Blog, Reddit, HN, Twitter/X	Awareness
1-2	OpenClaw provider listing + config snippet	Provider Directory, Discord	Acquisition
3-4	Quickstart guide: "OpenClaw + Gonka in 5 Minutes"	Blog, dev.to, Docs	Acquisition
3-4	Comparison post: "Gonka vs OpenRouter vs Together AI"	Reddit, Blog	Awareness
5-6	Video tutorial: config + first agent call	YouTube, Twitter/X	Activation
5-6	Session persistence deep-dive	Blog	Retention
7-8	Benchmark results: K2.5 agent performance	Twitter/X, Blog	Awareness
7-8	Privacy architecture post	Blog, Lobsters	Awareness (Privacy-First)
9-10	Cost calculator tool launch	Docs site	Retention
9-10	Reddit AMA / community Q&A	Reddit	Awareness + Acquisition
11-12	Developer spotlight: first power user	Blog, Twitter/X	Referral
11-12	Month 3 metrics review (internal)	Internal	–

Q2: Growth Quarter

Content allocation: 25% Awareness, 50% Activation + Retention, 25% Revenue + Referral

Q2 shifts focus to converting acquired developers into API-active users and retaining them. Awareness continues at reduced cadence to sustain the top of funnel.

- Bi-weekly deep-dive blog posts on sessions, tiering, memory API, webhooks
- Monthly developer spotlights and cost savings case studies
- Launch pricing page and ROI calculator
- Begin conference evaluation (submit CFPs for Q3 events)
- Cross-post best-performing blog content to dev.to/Hashnode

Q3+: Maturity Quarters

Content allocation: Balanced across all AAARRRP stages

- Content production is self-sustaining with established cadences per channel
- Community-generated content supplements official content (referral stage activating)
- Conference talks and case studies provide credibility at scale
- Quarterly 70/30 split audit ensures channel investment remains balanced
- Product stage feedback shapes content roadmap (address top feature requests in content)

Content Production Guidelines

Every piece of Gonka developer-facing content must follow these rules, derived from the Phase 17 message house and vocabulary guidelines.

Messaging Rules

1. **Reference the Phase 17 message house** (gonka_message_house.md) before writing any content piece. The message hierarchy is: lead with cost reduction (VP1), support with tiering (VP2) and ease of integration (VP3), use privacy (VP4) only for Privacy-First Builder audience.

2. **Never use the 16 crypto terms on the never-say list** in developer-facing content: wallet, staking, mining, DePIN, Web3, gas, slashing, governance proposals, epochs, validators, tokenomics, consensus mechanism, on-chain, smart contract, token (as cryptocurrency), decentralized (as headline). Use the approved alternatives from the vocabulary guidelines table.
3. **Lead with heartbeat cost reduction (73%) as primary hook** per the Phase 17 core positioning statement. Every awareness and comparison piece should open with the heartbeat overhead problem and the session persistence solution before mentioning any other Gonka feature.
4. **Include an OpenClaw config snippet in every tutorial and guide.** The "product" in every content piece is the 3-field `openclaw.json` configuration: `baseUrl`, `apiKey`, `api: "openai-completions"`. If the content does not show how to use Gonka with OpenClaw, it is not actionable.
5. **Address at least one objection from the playbook** (gonka_objection_playbook.md) in every comparison post. Use the ACE framework (Acknowledge, Counter, Evidence). The most common objections to address: "never heard of Gonka" (universal), "is this a crypto thing?" (universal), "decentralized = unreliable" (Startup CTO).
6. **Each content piece targets one primary persona and one AAARRRP stage.** This is not optional. If a content piece tries to address all three personas simultaneously, it addresses none effectively. The Content-Journey Matrix above specifies which persona and stage each content type targets.

Quality Standards

- All cost claims cite specific pricing analysis data (Section 3 for tier costs, Section 5 for Gonka hidden cost analysis, Section 6 for monthly projections)
- All benchmark claims cite competitive feature matrix (Section 3 for K2.5, Section 7 for uptime)
- Honest concessions are included for Gonka's known weaknesses: single model (K2.5), no published SLA, no published pricing, TEE not yet built
- Content that looks like a DeFi protocol page instead of a cloud platform page is rejected and rewritten
- Visual style reference: Vercel, Supabase, Cloudflare blog – clean, developer-friendly, no crypto aesthetics

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Channel-Content Cross-Reference

For each P0 and P1 channel, the top 3 content pieces to produce first (prioritized backlog). This is the operational "what to build first" list.

P0 Channels

OpenClaw Provider Directory 1. Provider configuration page with copy-paste `openclaw.json` snippet and model card for `gonka/kimi-k2.5` 2. Troubleshooting guide for the two-step provider gotcha (provider definition + model allowlisting per STACK.md) 3. "Why Gonka?" comparison table on the provider page (sessions, tiering, cost savings – no crypto language)

OpenClaw GitHub 1. PR adding Gonka as a built-in provider (eliminates manual config for all developers) 2. Discussion post: "Gonka: Agent-Native Inference with Session Persistence" introducing Gonka to the OpenClaw community 3. Template response for cost-related issues: config snippet + heartbeat savings data + link to blog comparison

OpenClaw Discord 1. Pinned config snippet in #providers or #configuration channel 2. "Gonka vs OpenRouter cost comparison" post with specific tier data and savings breakdown 3. Session persistence tutorial: "How to set up Gonka sessions for your always-on agent"

P1 Channels

Technical Blog (docs.gonka.ai/blog) 1. "Cut Agent Inference Costs 73% with Gonka" – launch post with heartbeat math, session persistence explanation, before/after cost comparison, config snippet 2. "OpenClaw + Gonka in 5 Minutes" – quickstart guide with screenshots, curl verification, cost dashboard walkthrough 3. "Agent Sessions: Why Your Agent Pays for Context Twice" – deep-dive explaining why heartbeats waste tokens, how sessions fix it, and the architectural difference vs prompt caching

Twitter/X AI Developer Community 1. Launch thread: heartbeat overhead problem + session persistence solution + cost comparison graphic + config snippet 2. Benchmark graphic: K2.5 vs GPT-4o vs Claude on SWE-Bench and tool calling, with per-token cost comparison 3. "90-second setup" video clip: screen recording of adding Gonka to openclaw.json and making first call

Reddit (r/LocalLLaMA, r/OpenClaw) 1. "I compared OpenRouter, Together AI, and Gonka for my OpenClaw agent – here are the real costs" comparison post with token math 2. "Show r/LocalLLaMA: Gonka – agent-native inference with server-side sessions" launch post with config snippet 3. Monitoring + responses to "how do I reduce OpenClaw costs?" threads with specific data and config snippets

dev.to / Hashnode 1. Cross-posted "OpenClaw + Gonka in 5 Minutes" quickstart 2. Cross-posted "Cut Agent Inference Costs 73%" comparison post 3. "How to Add Session Persistence to Your OpenClaw Agent" tutorial adapted for dev.to format

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Measurement Cadence

Weekly Review

- **API key signups:** total new signups, source attribution (which channel referred them)
- **First-call-within-24h rate:** percentage of new signups who make their first API call within 24 hours
- **Channel-specific engagement:** Reddit upvotes/comments, Twitter referral clicks, Discord Gonka mentions, blog unique visitors
- **Content performance:** which content pieces drove signups vs which drove only views

Monthly Review

- **API-active developer count:** developers with >100 API calls in the past 30 days (the primary KPI)
- **Retention rate:** percentage of last month's API-active developers who remain API-active this month
- **Content-to-signup funnel:** full funnel from content view to signup to first call to API-active status, by content piece
- **Channel ROI ranking:** channels ranked by API-active developers attributed, not by engagement metrics
- **Session adoption rate:** percentage of API-active developers using the sessions API (indicates agent-native feature adoption)

Quarterly Review

- **70/30 split audit:** actual channel investment (time, money, content pieces) measured against the 70/30 AI-dev/crypto target – adjust if drifting
- **Persona reach assessment:** are all three personas being reached, or has content skewed to one? Check referral sources against persona indicators
- **Channel promotion/demotion:** should any P2 channel be promoted to P1 based on conversion data? Should any P1 channel be demoted?
- **Content theme effectiveness:** which message house value propositions (VP1-VP5) generate the most API-active developer conversions? Double down on winners
- **Quarterly content plan:** set next quarter's content calendar based on this quarter's data, maintaining AAARRRP stage allocation appropriate to the growth phase

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Document: gonka_channel_strategy.md | Version 1.0 | 2026-04-01 Dependencies: gonka_developer_personas.md (Phase 16), gonka_message_house.md (Phase 17), gonka_objection_playbook.md (Phase 17) Sources: ARCHITECTURE.md (Component 4), PITFALLS.md, gonka_competitive_feature_matrix.md, gonka_agent_pricing_analysis.md